

Field CHA-021

71 acres in Champaign County, Illinois. What the satellite record shows for the 2026 season.

Prepared Oct 6, 2026
Imagery through Oct 2, 2026
Field Record (working name)



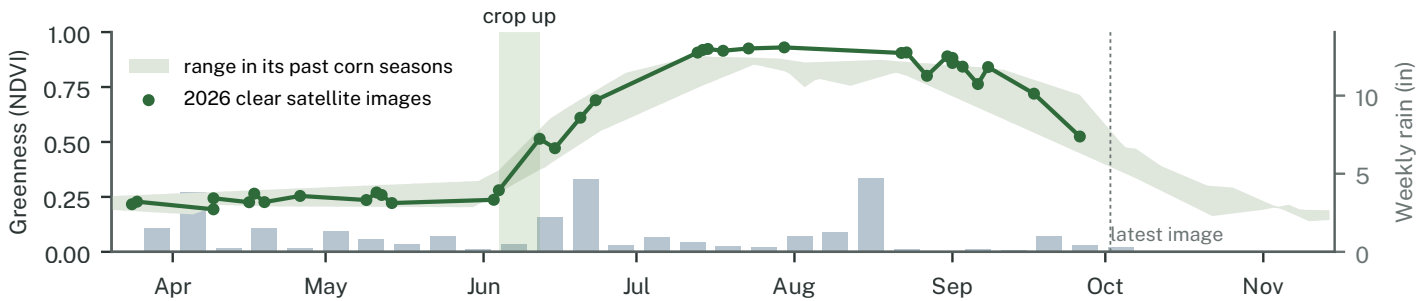
USDA NAIP aerial photo, 2023. Field boundary in yellow.

2026 crop	Corn (high confidence)
Crop came up	between Jun 4 and Jun 12, so likely planted May 21 to Jun 5
Harvest	crop still green in the last clear image (Sep 26)
After the 2025 harvest	Tilled (fall); residue dropped between Oct 16, 2025 and Oct 31, 2025
Winter 2025-26	Unclear: a little green in 9 winter images, below the cover-crop threshold
Season greenness	2nd greenest of its 4 corn seasons since 2020; 6th percentile of 1,520 Champaign County corn fields

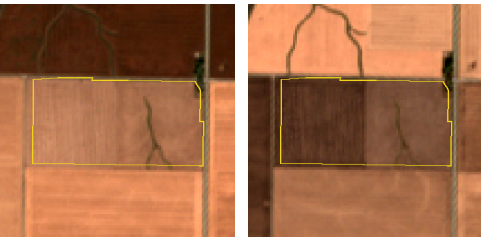
2019 Soybeans	2020 Corn	2021 Soybeans	2022 Corn	2023 Soybeans	2024 Corn	2025 Soybeans	2026 Corn
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Crop by year: USDA Cropland Data Layer 2019-2025; 2026 from our model.

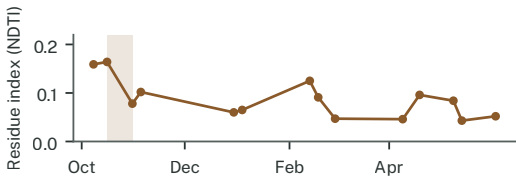
The 2026 season



After the 2025 harvest



Oct 16, 2025, Sentinel-2 (before)
Oct 31, 2025, Sentinel-2 (after)



Worth a look

Nothing inside the boundary stood out in the last four seasons: no persistent low spots, no hot spots, no change in land use.

This field is in corn for 2026, and the crop was up by Jun 12. Harvest has not shown up in the imagery yet; the latest clear image is from Sep 26. Through the summer it stayed behind most corn fields in the county (6th percentile on greenness), which tracks crop vigor but is not a yield estimate. It was tilled after last year's harvest (between Oct 16, 2025 and Oct 31, 2025), and nothing inside the boundary stood out as a problem area.

Evidence. Dates above rest on these satellite scenes: Oct 16 2025, tillage (S2C T16TDK orbit 126); Oct 31 2025, tillage (S2B T16TDK orbit 126); Jun 4 2026, crop up (Landsat 8 path/row 023032); Jun 12 2026, crop up (Landsat 9 path/row 023032); Jul 30 2026, peak (Landsat 9 path/row 023032); Sep 26 2026, dry-down, harvest (S2B T16TDK orbit 126). The chart and winter checks use 76 clear images from Aug 2025 on, all listed in the field record file.

How it was made. Greenness is NDVI and the residue index is NDTI, averaged 10 m inside the boundary (USDA NASS Crop Sequence Boundaries). Crop up is when greenness first passed 0.30; planting is estimated 1-2 weeks earlier. Hot spots use Landsat 8/9 surface temperature. Season greenness tracks crop vigor and is not a yield estimate.